

Question 9 · Unit 1 · 8 Marks

A growing organisation is facing skill gaps and declining employee performance. Suggest an HRD-oriented approach to address these issues.

Answer

An HRD-oriented approach treats skill gaps and falling performance as development problems, not only control or punishment problems.

- 1. Diagnose systematically:** Conduct organisation, task and person analysis. Separate skill gaps from motivation, process or resource problems.
- 2. Strengthen HRD climate:** Restore trust, feedback and support so employees will admit gaps and learn. Punitive climate hides problems.
- 3. Developmental performance appraisal:** Use appraisal to identify specific KSA gaps and agree on improvement plans, not only to rate people.
- 4. Targeted training and on-the-job learning:** Design training from TNA; combine coaching, job rotation and formal programmes.
- 5. Counselling and feedback:** Managers should counsel poor performers, set goals and review progress.
- 6. Career and potential focus:** For a growing firm, map future roles and start developing people for expansion, not only current jobs.
- 7. Involve line managers:** Make every supervisor responsible for developing their team; HRD specialist supports them.
- 8. Evaluate and iterate:** Measure behaviour and results (Kirkpatrick-type evaluation), then refine interventions.

***Conclusion.** This HRD approach closes skill gaps through diagnosis, climate, appraisal, learning and follow-up, which is more sustainable than hiring or firing alone.*